

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 11

Mu'rab Ghayr Munsarif Nouns

1. Recognising the Ism

أَمْ كُنْتُمْ شُهَدَاءَ إِذْ حَضَرَ يَعْقُوبَ الْمَوْتُ إِذْ قَالَ لِنَبِيِّهِ مَا تُعْبُدُونَ مِنْ بَعْدِي ۖ قَالُوا نَعْبُدُ إِلَهَكَ وَالْهَ أَبَاتَكَ إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَإِسْمَاعِيلَ وَإِسْحَاقَ إِلَهًا وَاحِدًا ۖ وَنَحْنُ لَهُ مُسْلِمُونَ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 133)

An *Ism* is a word that is the name of a person, place or thing. It has three outward marks: **أل** at the beginning (as in **الْحَمْدُ**), a round taa' at the end (as in **كَلِمَةً**), and *Tanween* at the end (as in **سَمَاءً ، سَمَاءً ، سَمَاءً**).

The nouns present in the verse

- Recognised by their outward marks: **الْمَوْتُ ، إِلَهًا ، وَاحِدًا**
- Recognised as being names of persons: **يَعْقُوبَ ، إِبْرَاهِيمَ ، إِسْمَاعِيلَ ، إِسْحَاقَ**
- Recognised by their plural form: **شُهَدَاءَ** (the *Jam' Mukassar* of **شَهِيد**) and **مُسْلِمُونَ** (the *Jam' Salim* of **مُسْلِم**)

2. Why is there no Tanween?

Singular nouns and the *Jam' Mukassar*, whether masculine or feminine, are *Marfoo'* with two pesh, *Mansoob* with two zabar and *Majroor* with two zer. And when **أل** is placed at their beginning, a single pesh replaces the two pesh, a single zabar the two zabar, and a single zer the two zer.

But in the verse above the names of persons and the word **شُهَدَاءَ** carry no *Tanween* at all; they come with a single vowel, even though no **أل** has entered them. The reasons for this are as follows.

Nouns that never take Tanween at their end

Kind	Examples
Tathniyah nouns, masculine and feminine	مُسْلِمَانِ ، مُسْلِمَتَيْنِ ، مُسْلِمَاتَانِ ، مُسْلِمَتَيْنِ
Jam' Salim Mudhakkar	مُسْلِمُونَ ، مُسْلِمِينَ

Singular nouns and the *Jam' Mukassar* are those that do take *Tanween* at the end. There can be two reasons for its absence in them:

- First: when **أل** comes at the beginning, no *Tanween* comes at the end.
- Second: some singular and *Jam' Mukassar* nouns never take *Tanween* at all and are *Majroor* with a zabar. Such nouns are called *Ghayr Munsarif* nouns.

3. The basic division: Mu'rab and Mabni

Kind	Proportion	Definition	Example
Mu'rab nouns	98 percent	Nouns that change shape in the different states of I'raab	قَلَمٌ ، قَلَمًا ، قَلَمٍ
Mabni nouns	2 percent	Nouns that keep one and the same shape in all three states of I'raab	هَذَا ، ذَلِكَ

The I'raab of a Mabni: *Mabni* nouns never alter their final vowel in any state of *I'raab*. Their *I'raab* is reckoned *mahallan* — by position rather than by any visible vowel. The word **هَذَا** stays the same whether *Marfoo'*, *Mansoob* or *Majroor*; only its position changes.

The eight principal groups of Mabni nouns

Group	Examples	Note
1. Dama'ir	هُوَ ، أَنْتَ ، أَنَا	These are always Mabni
2. Asma' ul Isharah	هَذَا ، ذَلِكَ	The dual forms of the Isharah are not Mabni
3. Asma' ul Mawsulah	الَّذِي ، الَّتِي	Here too the dual is excepted
4. Asma' ul Istifham	مَنْ ، مَا ، كَيْفَ ، أَيْنَ ، مَتَى	أَي is not Mabni but Mu'rab Munsarif
5. Asma' ush Shart	مَنْ ، مَا ، إِذَا	—
6. Asma' ul Af'al	هَيْهَاتَ ، أَمِينٌ ، صَهْ	Nouns that carry the sense of a verb

Group	Examples	Note
7. Compound numerals 11 to 19	أَحَدَ عَشَرَ ، خَمْسَةَ عَشَرَ	Both parts are Mabni upon a fathah
8. Certain Zuruf	حَيْثُ ، الآنَ ، أَمْسِ	Particular words denoting time or place

In the numeral twelve the second part عَشَرَ remains **Mabni**, while the first part changes exactly like a **Tathniyah**, giving اِثْنَا عَشَرَ and اِثْنَيْ عَشَرَ.

4. The two kinds of Mu'rab noun

The word **munsarif** comes from **sarf**, which means changing. From the same root comes **'Ilm us Sarf**, the study of the changes that occur in word forms.

Kind	Proportion	Characteristics
Mu'rab Munsarif	85 percent	They take three shapes in the three states of I'raab. Their mark is the Tanween, and in the state of nasb an alif is added along with the two zabar.
Mu'rab Ghayr Munsarif	13 percent	They take only two shapes in the three states. They never carry Tanween, and the states of nasb and jarr have one and the same shape, namely a single zabar. They do not accept a kasrah in the state of jarr.

Two kinds of noun fall under the **Munsarif**: the singular and the **Jam' Mukassar**. The **Ghayr Munsarif** too is only ever a singular or a **Jam' Mukassar**.

Halat ur Raf'	Halat un Nasb	Halat ul Jarr
قَلَمٌ	قَلَمًا	قَلَمٍ
قُلُوبٌ	قُلُوبًا	قُلُوبٍ

5. The groups of Ghayr Munsarif nouns

Since a **Ghayr Munsarif** noun has one and the same shape in the states of **nasb** and **jarr**, both are placed in a single column in the table below.

Group	Halat ur Raf'	Halat un Nasb wal Jarr
1. Names of the Prophets	إِبْرَاهِيمُ ، إِسْمَاعِيلُ ، يُوسُفُ	إِبْرَاهِيمَ ، إِسْمَاعِيلَ ، يُوسُفَ
2. Arabic feminine proper names	آمِنَةُ ، خَدِيجَةُ ، عَائِشَةُ ، مَرْيَمُ	آمِنَةً ، خَدِيجَةً ، عَائِشَةً ، مَرْيَمَ

Group	Halat ur Raf'	Halat un Nasb wal Jarr
3. Men's names ending in a round ة	طَلْحَةُ ، أُسَامَةُ ، حَمْرَةُ	طَلْحَةُ ، أُسَامَةُ ، حَمْرَةُ
4. Men's names ending in aan	عُثْمَانُ ، سَلْمَانُ ، عَدْنَانُ	عُثْمَانُ ، سَلْمَانُ ، عَدْنَانُ
5. Names of countries and cities	مَكَّةُ ، بَابِلُ ، رُومُ	مَكَّةُ ، بَابِلُ ، رُومُ
6. Names of angels	جِبْرِيلُ ، مِيكَالُ ، هَارُوتُ	جِبْرِيلُ ، مِيكَالُ ، هَارُوتُ
7. Non-Islamic names	إِسْرَائِيلُ ، جَالُوتُ	إِسْرَائِيلُ ، جَالُوتُ
8. Miscellaneous nouns	إِبْلِيسُ ، فِرْعَوْنُ ، قَارُونُ ، جَهَنَّمُ	إِبْلِيسُ ، فِرْعَوْنُ ، قَارُونُ ، جَهَنَّمُ
9. Alwan and 'Uyub — masculine	أَحْمَرُ ، أَخْضَرُ ، أَصْفَرُ	أَحْمَرُ ، أَخْضَرُ ، أَصْفَرُ
10. Alwan and 'Uyub — feminine	حَمْرَاءُ ، خَضْرَاءُ ، صَفْرَاءُ	حَمْرَاءُ ، خَضْرَاءُ ، صَفْرَاءُ
11. Ism ut Tafdeel	أَكْرَمُ ، أَكْبَرُ ، أَفْضَلُ	أَكْرَمُ ، أَكْبَرُ ، أَفْضَلُ
12. Adjectives on the pattern فَعْلَانُ	جَوْعَانُ ، عَطْشَانُ ، غَضَبَانُ	جَوْعَانُ ، عَطْشَانُ ، غَضَبَانُ
13. Jam' Mukassar with an Alif Mamdudah	أَنْبِيَاءُ ، فَقَرَاءُ ، أَغْنِيَاءُ	أَنْبِيَاءُ ، فَقَرَاءُ ، أَغْنِيَاءُ
14. Jam' Mukassar with a doubled letter after the alif	دَوَابُّ ، صَوَافٍ	دَوَابُّ ، صَوَافٍ
15. Jam' Mukassar on the pattern مَفَاعِلُ	مَذَاهِبُ ، مَسَاجِدُ ، مَقَابِرُ	مَذَاهِبُ ، مَسَاجِدُ ، مَقَابِرُ
16. Jam' Mukassar on the pattern مَفَاعِيلُ	قَوَارِيرُ ، مَسَاكِينُ	قَوَارِيرُ ، مَسَاكِينُ

- Six of the Prophets' names are not *Ghayr Munsarif*: شُعَيْبٌ ، لُوطٌ ، هُودٌ ، صَالِحٌ ، نُوحٌ ، مُحَمَّدٌ.
- The feminine of the *Ism ut Tafdeel*, كُبْرَى and صُغْرَى, keeps one shape in all three states because it ends in an *Alif Maqsurah*.
- Further miscellaneous nouns: يَأْجُوجُ ، مَأْجُوجُ ، آدَمُ ، إِرَمُ ، نُؤُدُ ، طَالُوتُ ، يَعْقُوقُ ، يَعْثُوتُ

Evidence from the Qur'an

فَتَلَقَّى آدَمُ مِنْ رَبِّهِ كَلِمَاتٍ فَتَابَ عَلَيْهِ ۚ إِنَّهُ هُوَ التَّوَّابُ الرَّحِيمُ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 37)

وَاتَّبَعُوا مَا تَتْلُوا الشَّيَاطِينُ عَلَىٰ مُلْكٍ سُلَيْمٍ ۖ وَمَا كَفَرَ سُلَيْمٌ وَلَكِنَّ الشَّيَاطِينَ كَفَرُوا يُعَلِّمُونَ النَّاسَ السِّحْرَ ۖ وَمَا أُنزِلَ عَلَى الْمَلَكَيْنِ بِبَابِلَ

هَارُوتَ وَمَارُوتَ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 102)

Look closely at بِبَابِل in this verse. Despite following the *Harful Jarr* baa', it carries a zabar rather than a zer, because it is *Ghayr Munsarif*. Likewise هَارُوتَ and مَارُوتَ come with a zabar.

وَالَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا أَعْمَالُهُمْ كَسَرَابٍ بِقِيعَةٍ يَحْسَبُهُ الظَّمْآنُ مَاءً ۖ حَتَّىٰ إِذَا جَاءَهُ لَمْ يَجِدْهُ شَيْئًا

(Surah an-Nur: 39) فَعَلَان — an adjective on the pattern الظَّمْآنُ

6. When does a Ghayr Munsarif become Munsarif?

A *Ghayr Munsarif* noun accepts a kasrah in the state of *jarr* and becomes *Munsarif* in two cases.

First case: alif lam comes at its beginning

Noun	Halat ur Raf'	Halat un Nasb	Halat ul Jarr
أَسْوَدَ	أَسْوَدُ	أَسْوَدَ	أَسْوَدَ
الْأَسْوَدَ	الْأَسْوَدُ	الْأَسْوَدَ	الْأَسْوَدَ
مَسَاكِينِ	مَسَاكِينُ	مَسَاكِينِ	مَسَاكِينِ
الْمَسَاكِينِ	الْمَسَاكِينُ	الْمَسَاكِينِ	الْمَسَاكِينِ

وَكُلُوا وَاشْرَبُوا حَتَّىٰ يَتَبَيَّنَ لَكُمُ الْخَيْطُ الْأَبْيَضُ مِنَ الْخَيْطِ الْأَسْوَدِ مِنَ الْفَجْرِ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 187)

Second case: it becomes Mudaf

When a *Ghayr Munsarif* noun becomes *Mudaf* to another noun, it likewise becomes *Munsarif* and takes a kasrah in the state of *jarr*.

إِنَّمَا الصَّدَقَتُ لِلْفُقَرَاءِ وَالْمَسْكِينِ وَالْعَمِلِينَ عَلَيْهَا وَالْمَوْلَافَةَ قُلُوبُهُمْ فِي الرِّقَابِ وَالْغُرَمِينَ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ وَابْنِ السَّبِيلِ ۖ فَرِيضَةً مِّنَ اللَّهِ

(Surah at-Tawbah: 60)

7. Asbab Man' as-Sarf

The sixteen groups set out above are for practical recognition. Behind them all, however, lies one governing principle, and once it is grasped all those groups become clear of themselves.

The governing definition: A *Ghayr Munsarif* is a noun in which **two of the Asbab Man' as-Sarf** are found, or in which there is found **a single cause that stands in place of two**. Such a noun takes neither *Tanween* nor a *kasrah*.

7.1 The nine causes

#	Cause	Brief sense
1	'Adl	A noun turning away from its original form to another form
2	Wasf	A noun denoting an entity in which some quality is also comprised
3	Ta'neeth	The noun being feminine
4	Ma'rifah	The noun being an 'alam, that is, a proper name
5	'Ujmah	The noun being a word of a non-Arabic language
6	Jam'	The noun being on one of the patterns of Muntaha al-Jumoo'
7	Tarkeeb	Two or more nouns merging into one
8	Wazn ul Fi'l	The noun being on one of the patterns of verbs
9	Alif Nun Za'idatan	An alif and a nun that are additional at the end of a noun

7.2 The first cause: 'Adl

The literal meaning of '*adl* is to change a thing from its original weight or state. In the terminology of *Nahw*, '*adl* means that a noun leaves its original form and passes to another form without any morphological rule, while the letters of the root remain. So عَمَرَ gives زُفِرَ and زَافِرٌ gives زُفِرَ.

The noun that has been turned from another form is called the *ma'dul*, and the form from which it was turned is the *ma'dul 'anhu*. So عَمَرَ and زُفِرَ are *ma'dul*, while عَامِرٌ and زَافِرٌ are *ma'dul 'anhu*.

Kind	Definition	Example
'Adl Tahqeeqi	A ma'dul noun in which, besides its being Ghayr Munsarif, there is also evidence of its having been turned from the original form	ثُلْتُ ، أَحَادُ ، رَبَاعُ
'Adl Taqdeeri	A ma'dul noun in which, besides its being Ghayr Munsarif, there is no such evidence	عَمَرُ ، زُفِرُ ، زُحُلُ

The word ثَلَاث means "three by three". From this it is known that its origin is ثَلَاثَة ثَلَاثَة, since repetition of meaning points to repetition of the word. Numerals from one to ten, when they come on the pattern فَعَالُ or مَفْعَلُ, contain 'Adl Tahqeeqi, as in مَعْشَرُ، عَشَارُ، مَرْبَعُ، رُبَاعُ، مَوْحَدُ، مُحَادُ، أَحَادُ. Two causes are present in them: *wasf* and 'adl.

Why 'Adl Taqdeeri was supposed: In the view of the grammarians a noun becomes *Ghayr Munsarif* only when two causes are found in it. In عُمَرُ and زُفَرُ no second cause besides being a proper name is apparent, yet the Arabs pronounce them as *Ghayr Munsarif*. For this reason a second cause, 'adl, was supposed in them, and they were taken to have been turned from عَامِرُ and زَافِرُ.

7.3 The second cause: Wasf

Wasf means that a noun points to an entity in which some quality of it is also comprised. So أَحْمَرُ (red) points to an entity together with which redness is comprised. The same holds for أَخْضَرُ and أَسْوَدُ.

The condition for Wasf: For *wasf* to become a cause of *man' as-sarf*, the condition is that it must be a *wasf in its original coinage* — that is, the word must have been coined for a qualifying sense from the outset, as أَبْيَضُ and أَسْوَدُ were.

Kind	Example	Ruling
Sifah Mushabbahah	أَحْمَرُ	Ghayr Munsarif — two causes: wasf and wazn ul fi'l
Ism ut Tafdeel	أَجْدَرُ، أَلْيَقُ	Ghayr Munsarif — two causes: wasf and wazn ul fi'l
Ism ul Fa'il	ذَاهِبٌ، قَائِمٌ	Munsarif — because only one cause is present
Ism ul Ma'ful	مَضْرُوبٌ، مَغْسُولٌ	Munsarif — because only one cause is present

7.4 The third cause: Ta'neeth

- *Ta'neeth Lafzi* — a noun at whose end some mark of the feminine is present, that is, the *Taa' Marbutah*.
- *Ta'neeth bil Alif* — when the mark of the feminine is an *Alif Maqsurah* or an *Alif Mamdudah*.
- *Ta'neeth Ma'nawi* — a noun with no mark of the feminine but feminine in meaning, such as the *Sama'i Mu'annath*.

The conditions: *Ta'neeth bil Alif* — whether the *Alif Mamdudah* or the *Alif Maqsurah* — **stands in place of two causes**, and there is no condition at all for its becoming a cause of *man' as-sarf*. *Ta'neeth Lafzi*, by contrast, becomes a cause only **on condition that the feminine noun is an 'alam**, as in *عَائِشَةُ* and *فَاطِمَةُ*.

7.5 The remaining six causes

Cause	Details and condition	Examples
Ma'rifah	Of the categories of Ma'rifah only the <i>Ism ul 'Alam</i> counts. Being an 'alam is not enough on its own; another cause must accompany it.	أَحْمَدُ ، مَكَّةُ
'Ujmah	Being a word of a non-Arabic language. The condition is that it be an 'alam in its own language and more than three letters.	إِبْرَاهِيمُ ، يُوسُفُ ، إِدْرِيسُ
Jam'	The noun being on one of the patterns of <i>Muntaha al-Jumoo'</i> . This stands in place of two causes and has no condition.	مَسَاجِدُ ، مَصَائِجُ
Tarkeeb	Two nouns merging into one (<i>Tarkeeb Mazji</i>), without <i>idafah</i> and without predication.	بَعْلَبُكُ ، خَضِرْمُوْتُ ، مَعْدِيكَرُبُ
Wazn ul Fi'l	The noun being on one of the patterns of verbs, or beginning with one of the letters of the <i>Fi'l Mudari'</i> (ا، ت، ي، ن).	أَحْمَدُ ، يَزِيدُ ، يَشْكُرُ ، تَغْلِبُ ، يَثْرِبُ
Alif Nun Za'idatan	An alif and a nun that are additional at the end of the noun, that is, not part of the root letters.	عُثْمَانُ ، عِمْرَانُ ، رَمَضَانُ ، سَلِيمَانُ

8. Nouns made Ghayr Munsarif by a single cause

Two cases render a noun *Ghayr Munsarif* on their own, without a second cause, because each stands in place of two.

8.1 Ta'neeth bil Alif

Nouns ending in an *Alif Maqsurah* or an *Alif Mamdudah*. There is no condition attached. So حُبْلَى (pregnant), كُبْرَى and رُجْعَى are *Ghayr Munsarif* on account of the *Alif Maqsurah*, and زَرْقَاءُ ، حَمْرَاءُ and صَخْرَاءُ on account of the *Alif Mamdudah*.

A fine point: Nouns ending in an *Alif Maqsurah* are read like a *Mabni*, but they are not in reality *Mabni*. Their *I'raab* is *taqdeeri*, which is why حُبْلَى is written in one and the same shape in all three states.

Halat ur Raf'	Halat un Nasb	Halat ul Jarr
حَمْرَاءُ	حَمْرَاءَ	حَمْرَاءِ
زُرْقَاءُ	زُرْقَاءَ	زُرْقَاءِ
صَحْرَاءُ	صَحْرَاءَ	صَحْرَاءِ

8.2 Muntaha al-Jumoo'

The expression مُنْتَهَى الْجُمُوعِ is made of two words. مُنْتَهَى literally means the utmost limit, the end, or the place of ending; and الْجُمُوعِ is the plural of *jam'*. So it means the limit of the plurals.

Definition: A plural after whose *alif ul jam'* there are two letters, or three letters provided the middle one is silent (usually a yaa'). It is called *Muntaha al-Jumoo'* because in Arabic no further plural of that word can be formed after it. It is the strongest of the *Asbab Man' as-Sarf*, and alone suffices to render a word *Ghayr Munsarif*.

For instance, the plural of مَسْجِدٌ is مَسَاجِدُ, which is itself *Muntaha al-Jumoo'*; no plural comes after it. Whereas كَلْبٌ has a plural أَكْلَبُ, and from that a further plural أَكَالِبُ is formed. Now أَكَالِبُ stands on the pattern of *Muntaha al-Jumoo'*, so the limit is reached here. If any plural is formed after it, it will be a *Jam' Salim* and not a *Jam' Mukassar*.

Pattern	Examples (singular in brackets)
مَفَاعِلُ	مَسَاجِدُ (مَسْجِدٌ) ، رَسَائِلُ (رِسَالَةٌ) ، مَنَاهِجُ (مَنْهَجٌ) ، مَنَازِلُ (مَنْزِلٌ)
مَفَاعِيلُ / فَعَالِيلُ	مَفَاتِيحُ (مِفْتَاحٌ) ، أَسَابِيغُ (أَسْبُوغٌ) ، دَرَاهِمُ (دِرْهَمٌ) ، قَنَادِيلُ (قَنْدِيلٌ)

Singular yet Ghayr Munsarif: Some singular nouns too are *Ghayr Munsarif*, because they happen to fall on one of the patterns of *Muntaha al-Jumoo'*. Thus طَمَاطِمُ (tomato) and بَطَاطِسُ (potato) are on the pattern مَفَاعِلُ, and likewise سَرَائِلُ (trousers) is *Ghayr Munsarif* for being on the pattern مَفَاعِيلُ.

9. Nouns made Ghayr Munsarif by two causes

Being an '*alam*' is itself one cause, but it is not sufficient alone. When any one of the six causes below joins it, the word becomes *Ghayr Munsarif*. Note that *wasf* and '*alam*' cannot combine.

Combination	Explanation	Examples
' <i>Alam</i> + ' <i>Ujmah</i>	The proper name is non-Arabic, of more than three letters, and an ' <i>alam</i> ' in its own language too	إِبْرَاهِيمُ ، يُوسُفُ ، يُونُسُ ، دَاوُدُ ، سُلَيْمَنُ ، بَاكِسْتَانُ
' <i>Alam</i> + Ta' <i>neeth</i>	It is a feminine name, whether or not it ends in a round ة	فَاطِمَةُ ، زَيْنَبُ ، طَلْحَةُ (a man's name yet feminine in form)
' <i>Alam</i> + Alif Nun Za'idatan	An additional alif and nun at the end, not part of the root letters	عِمْرَانُ (ع م ر) ، عَثْمَانُ (ع ث م) ، رَمَضَانُ (ر م ض)
' <i>Alam</i> + Wazn ul Fi'l	The noun stands on a pattern found among the verbs	أَحْمَدُ (أَفْعَلُ) ، يَزِيدُ (يَفْعَلُ) ، يَشْكُرُ ، تَغْلِبُ
' <i>Alam</i> + Tarkeeb	Formed by the merging of two nouns, neither a Murakkab Idafi nor a sentence	بَغْلَبَكُ ، حَضْرَمَوْتُ ، مَعْدِيكَرَبُ
' <i>Alam</i> + ' <i>Adl</i>	The name has turned from its original pattern to another, usually فُعْل	عُمَرُ (from عَامِر) ، زُحَلُ

A second cause alongside Ta'*neeth* Ma'*nawi*

Ta'neeth Ma'nawi is a noun with no outward mark of the feminine which native speakers nonetheless treat as feminine. For *man' as-sarf* it is required that the feminine noun be an '*alam*', and if along with that any one of the following three is present, it becomes obligatory to read it as *Ghayr Munsarif*:

- The noun consists of more than three letters, as in زَيْنَبُ
- If it is of three letters, its middle letter carries a vowel, as in سَقَرُ
- The noun is non-Arabic, as in مَاهُ and جُورُ (names of cities)

Three-letter feminine nouns: If a feminine '*alam*' consists of three letters and its middle letter is silent, it may be either *Munsarif* or *Ghayr Munsarif*. This is why both هِنْدُ and هِنْدٌ are correct.

10. Important exceptions

10.1 Non-Arabic names that are Munsarif

If a non-Arabic name consists of only three letters and its middle letter is silent, it is counted *Munsarif*, that is, it can take *Tanween* and a kasrah, as in نُوحٌ ، لُوطٌ ، هُودٌ.

The principle for the Prophets' names: Generally all the names of the Prophets are non-Arabic and *Ghayr Munsarif*, except six. The first three of these — مُحَمَّدٌ ، صَالِحٌ ، شُعَيْبٌ — are purely Arabic names and therefore *Munsarif*. And the last three — نُوحٌ ، لُوطٌ ، هُودٌ — are indeed non-Arabic, yet are *Munsarif* for being of three letters with a silent middle letter.

10.2 The exception to Wazn ul Fi'l

If a name stands on the pattern of a verb but a round ة comes at its end, it falls outside this rule and becomes *Munsarif*. Thus يَعْمُرُ is *Ghayr Munsarif*, but يَعْمُرَةٌ will be *Munsarif*.

10.3 Exceptions to Alif Nun Za'idatan

If only two letters precede the alif and the nun, then that alif and nun are not additional but original, and in such a case the word is *Munsarif*, as in حَسَانٌ and سِنَانٌ.

A particular condition for the Wasf: When the alif and nun come to express a quality (generally on the pattern فَعْلَانُ), the condition for being *Ghayr Munsarif* is that its feminine must not come as فَعْلَانَةٌ. If the feminine comes on the pattern فَعْلَى, the word is *Ghayr Munsarif*, as in عَطُشَانُ (feminine عَطُشَى) and غَضَبَانُ (feminine غَضَبَى). And if the feminine comes with a round ة, the word is *Munsarif*, as in نَدَمَانُ (regretful), whose feminine is نَدَمَانَةٌ.

10.4 The discussion on the word Rahman

Lexicographers differ over the word رَحْمَنٌ. Those who hold it *Ghayr Munsarif* argue that no feminine رَحْمَانَةٌ is used for it, so it meets the rule that the feminine must not take a round ة. Those who hold it *Munsarif* argue that it has no feminine in use at all, so it may equally be called *Munsarif*. In the Hijazi dialect, which is the language of the Qur'an, nouns on the pattern فَعْلَانُ have been kept close to the rules of the *Ghayr Munsarif*.

10.5 The states of the Tarkeeb Mazji

A *Tarkeeb Mazji* is a name in which two words have been kneaded into one with no grammatical relation between them, as in بَعْلَبَكُّ (the name of a city in Lebanon), formed from بَعْل and بَك.

- *Halat ur Raf'*: هَذِهِ بَعْلَبَكُّ (this is Ba'labakk)
- *Halat un Nasb*: رَأَيْتُ بَعْلَبَكُّ (I saw Ba'labakk)
- *Halat ul Jarr*: سَكَنْتُ فِي بَعْلَبَكُّ (I lived in Ba'labakk) — a zabar has come here despite فِي being a *Harf ul Jarr*

Summary

1. The Ism has three outward marks: al- at the beginning, a round ى at the end, and Tanween at the end.
2. Tathniyah nouns and the Jam' Salim Mudhakkar never take Tanween at their end.
3. There are two reasons why a singular or a Jam' Mukassar may lack Tanween: either al- has entered it, or it is Ghayr Munsarif.
4. Nouns are of two kinds: Mu'rab (98 percent) and Mabni (2 percent). The I'raab of a Mabni is not visible but mahalli.
5. There are eight groups of Mabni nouns: Dama'ir, Asma' ul Isharah, Asma' ul Mawsulah, Asma' ul Istifham, Asma' ush Shart, Asma' ul Af'al, compound numerals, and certain Zuruf.
6. The Mu'rab is of two kinds: Munsarif (85 percent) and Ghayr Munsarif (13 percent).
7. A Munsarif takes three shapes in the three states, whereas a Ghayr Munsarif takes only two.
8. A Ghayr Munsarif never takes Tanween and does not accept a kasrah in the state of jarr, being Majroor with a zabar instead.
9. A Ghayr Munsarif is only ever a singular or a Jam' Mukassar.
10. The names of the Prophets are Ghayr Munsarif, except six: Muhammad, Nuh, Salih, Hud, Lut and Shu'ayb.
11. A Ghayr Munsarif becomes Munsarif in two cases: when al- enters it, and when it becomes Mudaf.
12. The governing definition is that a Ghayr Munsarif is a noun in which two causes are found, or one cause that stands in place of two.
13. The Asbab Man' as-Sarf are nine: 'Adl, Wasf, Ta'neeth, Ma'rifah, 'Ujmah, Jam', Tarkeeb, Wazn ul Fi'l and Alif Nun Za'idatan.
14. 'Adl is of two kinds: 'Adl Tahqeeqi, for which there is evidence, as in ثَلَاثٌ; and 'Adl Taqdeeri, as in رُفْرُ and عُمَرُ.
15. The noun that has been turned is the ma'dul, and the form from which it was turned is the ma'dul 'anhu.
16. Wasf becomes a cause only when the noun is a wasf in its original coinage, which is why the Ism ul Fa'il and Ism ul Maf'ul remain Munsarif.
17. Ta'neeth bil Alif and Muntaha al-Jumoo' each stand in place of two causes and alone render a noun Ghayr Munsarif.
18. The two well-known patterns of Muntaha al-Jumoo' are مَفَاعِلٌ and مَفَاعِيلٌ. Some singular nouns become Ghayr Munsarif merely by falling on these patterns, as طَمَاطِمٌ and سَرَائِيلٌ do.
19. Being an 'alam is not enough on its own; it must be joined by 'Ujmah, Ta'neeth, Alif Nun Za'idatan, Wazn ul Fi'l, Tarkeeb or 'Adl.
20. Non-Arabic names of three letters with a silent middle letter are Munsarif, as نُوحٌ, لُوطٌ and هُودٌ are.

21. An adjective on the pattern فَعْلَان is Ghayr Munsarif only when its feminine comes on the pattern فَعْلَى, as عَطْشَانٌ does. If the feminine comes with a round ة it is Munsarif, as نَذْمَانٌ is.

Exercise

1. Write the three outward marks of an Ism, and take three nouns from Surah al-Baqarah verse 133 stating how each is recognised.
 2. Explain the difference between Mu'rab and Mabni nouns, and write four groups of the Mabni.
 3. Why is the I'raab of a Mabni called mahalli? Explain using هَذَا.
 4. Compare the Munsarif and the Ghayr Munsarif in three respects.
 5. Write any eight groups of Ghayr Munsarif nouns with examples.
 6. Write the six names of the Prophets that are Munsarif, and state the reason in each case.
 7. In which two cases does a Ghayr Munsarif become Munsarif? Give a Qur'anic example for each.
 8. Write the governing definition of the Ghayr Munsarif.
 9. Write the names of the nine Asbab Man' as-Sarf in order.
 10. Explain the difference between 'Adl Tahqeeqi and 'Adl Taqdeeri with examples.
 11. Define ma'dul and ma'dul 'anhu and give two examples.
 12. What is the condition for Wasf to become a cause of man' as-sarf? Why does the Ism ul Fa'il remain Munsarif?
 13. Which two causes render a noun Ghayr Munsarif on their own?
 14. Define Muntaha al-Jumoo' and write both of its well-known patterns with examples.
 15. Write the six causes that join with 'Alam, with examples.
 16. Why is عَطْشَانٌ Ghayr Munsarif while نَذْمَانٌ is Munsarif?
 17. Write all three states of بَعْلُكَ and comment particularly on the state of jarr.
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سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ